

MARCUS DEVRIES

Principal Engineer, Staff Level

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I am a Principal Engineer with 12 years of experience building scalable infrastructure and leading technical initiatives at high-growth companies. I started my career building backend systems in Python and Java, then shifted focus to cloud architecture and distributed systems. My strength lies in taking on ambiguous problems, designing solutions that teams actually want to maintain, and mentoring engineers who are two to three years behind me. I have led platform migrations affecting hundreds of services and have a track record of making pragmatic decisions when perfection is the enemy of progress.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

TechVault Systems

Amsterdam, Netherlands

<https://techvault.io>

January 2021 - Present

Led the migration of 200+ microservices from Kubernetes 1.16 to 1.28, establishing patterns that reduced deployment failures by 65 percent across the organization.

Designed and implemented an internal developer platform that improved service deployment time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes, directly enabling 40 percent faster feature velocity for product teams.

Mentored 6 senior engineers toward staff engineer promotions by structuring quarterly growth discussions and assigning projects that pushed them beyond their current capabilities.

Built a comprehensive disaster recovery strategy for our multi-region infrastructure that passed external audits and reduced our RTO from 4 hours to 12 minutes.

Senior Software Engineer

CloudFirst Solutions

Amsterdam, Netherlands

<https://cloudfirst.co>

June 2017 - December 2020

Architected a real-time data streaming platform using Apache Kafka and Apache Flink that handled 500 million events per day, serving analytics, fraud detection, and recommendation systems.

Led a team of 4 engineers in redesigning our service-to-service communication layer, which eliminated 90 percent of timeout-related incidents and improved p99 latency from 2.3 seconds to 340 milliseconds.

Implemented infrastructure-as-code practices using Terraform, managing 150+ cloud resources across staging and production environments while reducing manual provisioning errors by 87 percent.

Conducted weekly architecture review sessions with stakeholders, translating complex technical decisions into business impact and securing buy-in for investments in observability and reliability tools.

Software Engineer II

DataCore Technology

Utrecht, Netherlands

<https://datacore.net>

March 2012 - May 2017

Developed backend APIs in Python and Java that processed financial transaction data for 25 European banks, handling 10 million daily requests with 99.98 percent uptime.

Introduced automated testing practices to a legacy codebase, increasing test coverage from 18 percent to 78 percent and reducing production incidents by 42 percent in the first year.

Built and maintained PostgreSQL database schemas for systems managing terabytes of historical transaction data, optimizing slow queries and implementing partitioning strategies that improved query performance by 5 times.

Collaborated with infrastructure and security teams to implement TLS encryption, certificate rotation, and compliance auditing for GDPR and PCI-DSS standards across all production systems.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science

University of Amsterdam

Amsterdam, Netherlands

Graduated: May 2012

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, Go, SQL, Bash, YAML

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, CloudFormation), Azure, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Helm

Data and Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, Apache Kafka, Apache Flink

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, DataDog, ELK Stack, Jaeger (distributed tracing)

Architecture: Microservices, distributed systems, event-driven architecture, multi-region deployment, disaster recovery

DevOps and Tools: CI/CD (GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Jenkins), Linux administration, monitoring and alerting, infrastructure automation

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

[mdevries/k8s-multi-region-failover](#)

A production-tested library for managing automatic failover across Kubernetes clusters in different regions, used at TechVault Systems to achieve 12-minute RTO.

[mdevries/postgres-performance-toolkit](#)

A collection of diagnostic scripts and Grafana dashboards for identifying and resolving PostgreSQL query bottlenecks in large-scale systems.

[mdevries/observability-for-microservices](#)

Documentation and examples showing how to instrument distributed systems with Prometheus, Jaeger, and ELK for comprehensive observability.

[mdevries/terraform-aws-vpc-patterns](#)

Reusable Terraform modules for common VPC configurations, including multi-AZ setups, NAT gateway optimization, and security group patterns.